On 2 June 2008, Tata Motors finally completed the acquisition of Jaguar and Land Rover. The all-cash deal was principally funded by way of $3 billion of bridging loans. As part of the deal, Ratan also agreed that Ford should ‘continue to supply Jaguar Land Rover for differing periods with powertrains, stampings and other vehicle components’. This was in addition to providing ‘engineering support, including research and development’, plus other services such as accounting. The continued association with Ford was a conscious call that Ratan took to ensure uninterrupted production of vehicles.

Ratan termed the completion of the acquisition as a ‘momentous time’ for all at Tata Motors. In the interview to Harvard Business School in 2015, he called it an ‘interesting form of acquisition’. He said that before the Tatas purchased JLR, they ‘weren’t permitted to visit the plant’, ‘talk to the management’ or even ‘look at the dealerships’. They were denied all forms of access until Ford had decided on a ‘serious buyer’. The purchase was basically done ‘sight unseen’. However, after the acquisition, when Ratan finally got the chance to see what he had acquired, he said, ‘I was amazed at the level of technology we had, the engineering skills we had. It was on account of the manufacturing systems that Ford put in place—Ford and BMW—who, at different times, owned the company.’

The fascination once again came alive when he visited the Jaguar Heritage Museum at its old site near Birmingham, UK. There, he gushed about how the Jaguar brand had always attracted him and recollected his drives with his father. His ‘casual remark caused the gears to grind in the Jaguar Daimler Heritage Trust archives’ and he was soon ‘presented with his father’s order number from within the brown-leaved ledgers’. They also took him ‘for a spin in a similar car’.

Even after the acquisition, Ratan continued to reassure the workforce. He stated that the company was ‘looking forward to extending’ its complete ‘support to the Jaguar Land Rover team to realize their competitive potential’. He assured them that Jaguar and Land Rover would ‘retain their distinctive identities and continue to pursue their respective business plans as before’.

This continuous messaging slowly melted away the opposition from the workforce. David Smith, CEO of JLR, perhaps reflected that change most poignantly. In an interview to the *Financial Times*, he declared how the ethos of the Tata Group was, in fact, preferable to those of the American